

Sample SOP: Setting Up a New Staff Member on Microsoft 365

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About This Document

Table 1: Document details

Item	Detail
Version	1.0
Who owns this SOP	Business & Technology Coordinator
Approved by	Operations Manager
Last checked	1 October 2026
Next check	April 2027, or earlier if a system change

Note: I wrote this sample to show how I write process documents. The steps are general. In a real workplace, I would update them to match the company's own systems and IT partner.

Why We Use This Sop

By the end of their first day, a new staff member should be able to log in and do their job. They should have access to what their role needs, and no more than that.

This SOP is written for the Business & Technology Coordinator. In this document, "you" means the coordinator.

This SOP covers:

- setting up the Microsoft 365 account (email, Teams, SharePoint)
- getting access to business systems such as ERP and CRM
- getting the laptop or other device ready
- helping the person on their first day

It does not cover payroll, HR forms or building access cards. When a staff member leaves, use the Staff Offboarding SOP instead.

How long it takes: about 1 to 1.5 hours in total, spread over the week before the person starts.

Who Does What

Table 2: Roles and responsibilities

Person	What they do
Hiring manager	Shares the new starter's details and approves what systems and access they need
Business & Technology Coordinator	Raises the request, keeps track of it, follows up, helps on day one and closes the ticket
IT partner (outside IT company)	Creates the account, gives the licence, sets up the device and creates the temporary password
System owners (ERP, CRM)	Give the person access to their system at the right level

Before You Start

Ask the hiring manager for these details at least 5 working days before the start date. The manager must assess the systems and access level by email or in the ticket, so there is a clear record.

Table 3: New starter details

What you need	Example
Full name and job title	Mere Thompson, Sales Coordinator
Start date	Monday 2 November
Manager's name	David Brown
Team	Sales
Office or frontline staff	Office (or warehouse, driver, etc.)
Systems and access level	Outlook, Teams, SharePoint, ERP (view only), CRM (standard user)
Equipment	Laptop, headset, mobile phone
Personal mobile number	Only used to send the first-time password

If anything is missing, ask the manager the same day. Never guess what access someone needs.

Tip: Check the start date with the manager again 2 days before. Start dates often change, and it is easier to move the setup early than to fix it on the day.

Steps

Step 1: Raise a ticket with the IT partner (5 working days before)

Ask the IT partner for a Microsoft 365 account, the right licence and a device. Use their ticketing system, or Jira if the team tracks requests there. Add all the details above and the manager's approval. Write down the ticket number so you can track it.

Step 2: Check the account is ready (3 working days before)

Look for the new email address in the staff directory. Make sure the licence has been added.

Step 3: Add the person to their team groups (3 working days before)

Add them to their team's Teams channel, SharePoint site and email lists. Only add the groups the manager approved.

Step 4: Ask for business system access (3 working days before)

Contact each system owner (for example ERP and CRM) and ask them to set up the person at the approved level. Note each request in the ticket. If it is not done within 2 days, follow up.

Step 5: Check the device (1 working day before)

Confirm the IT partner has set up and tested the laptop. Turn it on and check it starts, connects to the network and shows the login screen. Do not log in as the new person.

Step 6: Email the hiring manager (1 working day before)

Send the username, the plan for day one and a link to the staff IT guide. Never put the password in this email.

Step 7: Share the password safely (day one)

The IT partner sends the temporary password by text to the new person's mobile or gives it to them in person. They must change it the first time they log in.

Step 8: Help on day one (about 30 minutes)

Sit with the new person and help them to:

- log in and change their password
- set up multi-factor authentication (MFA), which is a code sent to their phone to keep the account safe
- open Outlook, Teams and SharePoint, and check ERP and CRM work
- connect to the printer and save a file to SharePoint
- read and agree to the IT and acceptable use policy

Tip: Ask them to try one real task in each system, such as opening a customer record in CRM. Just opening the app does not always show if their access level is right.

Step 9: Check in at the end of week one

Ask the new person and their manager if anything is missing or not working.

Step 10: Close the ticket

Write down any problems and how they were fixed. Close the ticket once everything on the checklist is done.

Frontline And Warehouse Staff

Some staff, like warehouse workers or drivers, may not need a laptop or a full Microsoft 365 licence. For these staff:

- Check with the IT partner which licence they need. A cheaper frontline licence is often enough.
- Confirm which device they will use, such as a mobile phone, shared computer or handheld scanner.
- On shared devices, make sure each person has their own login. Passwords should never be shared.
- Plan the day-one help around their shift start time.

Common Problems And When To Get Help

Table 4: Common problems and solutions

Problem	Try this first	Contact the IT partner if
Cannot log in	Check the username spelling and that Caps Lock is off	The account is locked, cannot be found, or the password needs resetting
MFA is not working	Check the phone's date and time are correct, then send the MFA setup link again	It still fails after 2 tries
Teams channel or SharePoint site is missing	Check their group membership and add them again	It is still missing after 1 hour
No access to ERP or CRM	Follow up with the system owner	The owner says it is set up but it still does not work
Laptop problem	Restart it and check the network connection	It will not turn on or there is a hardware fault
Strange email or login alert	Tell the person not to click anything	Always contact them straight away

When you contact the IT partner, tell them: the person's name, what is wrong, what you have already tried, and how urgent it is. Add screenshots if you can.

How urgent is it?

- **High:** the person cannot work at all, or it could be a security problem
- **Medium:** the person can work but a key system is missing
- **Low:** a small problem with a way around it

Final Checklist

Tick on each item before closing the ticket.

- ☐ Manager's approval saved in the ticket
- ☐ Microsoft 365 account and correct licence working
- ☐ Temporary password changed
- ☐ MFA set up
- ☐ Outlook, Teams and SharePoint open with no errors
- ☐ Added to the right groups and email lists only
- ☐ Access to business systems working (ERP, CRM, others)
- ☐ Laptop and equipment working
- ☐ IT and acceptable use policy accepted
- ☐ Week-one check-in done
- ☐ Ticket updated and closed

Related Documents

- Staff Offboarding SOP (removing access when someone leaves)
- Staff IT Guide (kept on SharePoint or Confluence)
- IT and Acceptable Use Policy

Keeping this SOP up to date: Review it every 6 months, or sooner if a system or the IT partner's process changes. Record any changes in the "About this document" table.